Week 02 Interactive Data Portrait

Documentation

I decided to use the emotional data I collected over the course of four days (Monday through Thursday) for this interactive sketch, concentrating on the particular emotions I felt every time I picked up my phone. The types of emotions (such as tiredness, boredom, and stress) and their frequency on various days were the key things I carried over from Experiment 1. I chose this because the most significant finding in my first data was the recurring of certain emotions, particularly "tired." I wanted to highlight patterns and let them alter quickly rather than merely expressing the feelings visually, like in my hand-drawn portrait.

I concentrated on controls that complemented the structure of my data while choosing interactive components. Since my data was arranged by day, I represented the various days using a dropdown menu, which makes it simple for the viewer to navigate between them. In order to allow users to turn on and off particular emotions, I also included checkboxes. Because viewers can concentrate on specific emotions like tension or distraction, the experience becomes more intimate and exploratory. In order to build a visual hierarchy that reacts quickly to the data, I also employed size variation in the emojis to indicate how frequently an emotion occurs.

Viewers can discover details that are not as clear in the hand-drawn version by interacting with the drawing. For instance, it is evident to them that "tired" is the most common emotion because it outweighs the other ones. Additionally, they are able to identify patterns across several days and separate specific emotions that would be more difficult to identify in a static drawing. In addition to allowing for more in-depth investigation than merely observation, the interactivity gives the data a more dynamic aspect.

I experimented with interaction in this sketch by using coding as a tool, which felt like "vibe coding" in that I tried concepts, modified graphics, and learnt by making mistakes. Through this method, I was able to comprehend how minor adjustments, such as adding filters or scaling size, can have a big impact on how data is understood. I also learned how to connect data structures (like arrays and objects) to visual outputs in p5.js.

If I had more time, I would add animations to the project, such emotions moving in the direction of a central phone or responding to clicks. Additionally, I would investigate more complex interactions, such as monitoring the time of day or including sound to symbolize various moods. All things considered, this project improved my understanding of both my own behaviors and how interactivity can extract more meaningful information from basic data.